

Inflatable Penile Prosthesis (IPP)

Patient Information · What to expect with a penile implant

WARWIKI

A penile implant is a device placed completely inside your body. It lets you get a firm erection when you choose. It is for men whose erection problems have not improved with pills, injections or other treatments, or who prefer an implant after learning about all the choices.

About This Procedure

The implant has three parts, all hidden under the skin:

- Two **cylinders** inside the penis that fill with fluid to make it firm
- A **pump** in the scrotum
- A small **reservoir** of fluid in the lower belly

How you use it: squeeze the pump several times to fill the cylinders. When you are done, press the release on the pump to go soft. You decide when, and for how long.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

8 in 10

men are satisfied with their implant

1–3 in 100

get an infection after a first implant (higher with diabetes or a repeat operation)

3 in 4

implants still work after 10 years; many men need a repair at some point

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

What to Know Before You Decide

- **It is permanent.** After surgery, natural erections, pills and injections no longer work. The implant becomes how you get an erection. Never inject erection medicine into the penis once you have an implant; it can damage the device.
- **Feeling and orgasm:** your desire and orgasm stay. Urination and ejaculation usually do not change.
- **The erection is different.** It may seem shorter, narrower or less sensitive than your natural erections were. The head of the penis does not get firm.

Learn the Terms

Erectile dysfunction (ED)

Trouble getting or keeping an erection firm enough for sex.

Penile prosthesis (IPP)

The implanted device that gives an erection when you choose.

Cylinders

The two parts inside the penis that fill with fluid.

Pump

The part in the scrotum you squeeze to fill the cylinders.

Reservoir

The fluid holder placed in the lower belly.

Activation

The visit, about 4 to 6 weeks after surgery, when you are taught to use the implant.

Cycling

Filling and emptying the implant each day once it is activated.

Spinal anesthesia

A numbing shot in the back so you feel nothing from the waist down.

Will it hurt? You will be asleep or numb during surgery, so you feel nothing. Afterward, expect soreness, swelling and bruising of the penis and scrotum for a couple of weeks. Many men go home the same day.

Weeks 1–2

Swelling and bruising. Support, ice and pain medicine.

Until activation

Do not use the implant. Keep the penis pointing up toward your belly.

Weeks 4–6

Activation visit. Learn to fill and empty it. Sex once cleared.

After that

Cycle it daily at first. See your team once a year.

How to Get Ready

- Follow your surgery instructions about eating, drinking and which medicines to stop, including blood thinners.
- Preventing infection matters most.** Any infection, including a urine infection, is treated first. You will wash with antiseptic soap and get antibiotics.
- Stop smoking and vaping.** If you have diabetes, get your blood sugar under good control. Both lower the infection risk.

Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have diabetes, or trouble using your hands (you work the pump yourself)
- Have had pelvic or penile surgery, radiation, or an earlier implant

What Happens During Surgery

- 1 You receive general or spinal anesthesia and antibiotics.
- 2 Through one small cut, near the scrotum or low on the belly, the surgeon places the cylinders, pump and reservoir.
- 3 The implant is tested, then left empty to heal. You may have a catheter for a short time.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, swelling or pain that is getting worse, or fluid leaking from the cut
- Skin over the pump or penis that looks thin, shiny or broken

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate
- The penis turns dark, cold or very painful
- One leg becomes swollen, painful or cold
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. An implant gives a reliable erection when other treatments have failed. About 8 in 10 men are satisfied.
2. It is permanent, and the erection may feel shorter or less sensitive than before.
3. Preventing infection matters most. Do not use the implant until your activation visit.